

*As I  
Was Saying*

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## Rulesmakers Listen This Time

**SHORT SUBJECTS:** Motto of the NCAA rules committee in football sometimes in the past has been "Stop, Look and Don't Listen." The rules makers quite often adopted rules that were unpopular with the majority of coaches. But this year, they listened. They rescinded the punt rule which required that the interior linemen stand fast until the ball was actually kicked. Bobby Dobbs is in California on a recruiting mission and could not be reached to be sounded out. But I know he was opposed to the 1967 punting rule and will be glad that the restrictions on linemen charging down field have been lifted. However, the restrictive punt coverage rule last season didn't seem to make much difference as far as run-backs and adaptation were concerned. It worked out all right. The attendance was poor at the last



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Touchdown Club meeting but it was one of the best held since basketball replaced football on the agenda. Don Haskins let his hair down and talked informally and at length on the Miners and their games. The crowd liked it. Another meeting is slated Monday at the Sheraton. The Aggie game will be the chief topic. Andy Cohen is getting ready to launch baseball practice at UTEP. It's a big diamond year for the Miners with games scheduled against Arizona and Arizona State. Cohen asked Bobby Winkles, coach of the national champion ASU Sun Devils, to let him have his rejects. Good horse racing story paragraph: "He footballed his way through traffic to score going away." And Mel Durslag, Hearst Newspaper columnist, says: "Give him two weeks for preparation and Vince Lombardi might beat the Red Chinese."